



# Using Likewise to Integrate Linux with MS Active Directory

In this article, the author recounts his experience with Likewise, which was used to integrate Linux systems with Microsoft Active Directory, and also adds usage tips.

*I*n my current project, we have some desktops running Linux, but since the domain controller is Microsoft Active Directory (AD), we had to authenticate logins on these desktops against AD. I could have used Samba-Kerberos-AD authentication, but since I knew from prior experience that this was pretty complex, and not that elegant (for example, when creating users' home directories, etc) I chose to use Likewise instead. Likewise is an open source project, which can marry AD and Linux.

Likewise has two offerings: Likewise Open and Likewise Enterprise, which is the

commercial offering. I used the GPLed version, Likewise Open, which supports Kerberised services (systems, services or software that support authentication through Kerberos). Though Likewise is now a part of some distributions (like Ubuntu), since my servers are running Oracle Enterprise Linux, I had to download an installer from the Likewise site (<http://www.likewise.com/download/index.php>).

## Basic requirements

Apart from a working Active Directory server/domain controller, Likewise has the following requirements:

- A DNS server.